NOTE Even if you choose your governance team well, the people selected may still raise concerns about whether they should join your initiative. In our experience, the key is to introduce the data mesh as a socio-technological architecture, not as yet another technical solution. Including people with key business roles, and shaping the team early on, are critical for its proper functioning.

All of this will make the implementation process for data mesh much smoother, but the right implementation team still needs materials to work with. So in the next section, let's look at how to design and implement the building blocks of your data mesh: your data products.

3.3 Setting up MVP governance

It could seem that setting up governance is the least of our problems and that it could wait for all the important (technical) solutions related to the central platform to be in place or data products to be developed. But that's not exactly true. You don't want your governing body to be an afterthought.

Neither the platform nor data products you will develop at the MVP stage are likely to last, but your governing body will, at least in some capacity. You've chosen the data governance team members for their experience and influence. It would be a grave mistake to start your collaboration by reducing their role to rubber-stamping whatever you prepare for them.

What you can and will do is clearly state the purpose of your data governance team. To lay the cornerstone of data mesh data governance, this team will achieve two goals within the MVP span:

- To develop a value statement related to data governance policies and rules (we present the definition of a *value statement* in section 3.3.1)
- To set up initial rules and policies to govern the central platform and data products

Depending on the composition of your data governance team, you may decide that other goals are more relevant to your project. If so, in chapter 6, we suggest decisions that could be channeled to different central governance bodies. You may look to that chapter for inspiration.